TEACHER GUIDE · KINDERGARTEN · INTRO BLOCK CODING

Meet the Blocks

Quick facilitation notes & answer key

Goal

Children learn that a program is a stack of blocks that snap together and run from the top down, and that the green ⚑ GO block is the start block that always sits on top. This is the first idea of block coding (ScratchJr-style): code is built from blocks, and a program has a clear beginning.

Kindergarten frame (Ontario)

Problem Solving and Innovating — children recognize that coded instructions are assembled in order with a designated starting point.

No reading required of the child: read each prompt aloud; the child circles, marks A/B, or draws.

Materials

The printed worksheet, a pencil, and a green crayon. Optional: 3 paper blocks (1 green flag, 2 blue arrows) the child can physically stack.

Run it (about 15 min)

1. MODEL: point to Bit's program. 'The green flag block is on top, so it runs first — it starts the program. Then Bit runs each arrow block going down.'

2. GUIDED: Exercise 1 — children circle the green ⚑ block (the start). Exercise 2 — compare Stack A and Stack B; only Stack A has the ⚑ on top, so A is ready.

3. YOU TRY: Exercise 3 — children draw a ⚑ in the empty top block and colour it green to make the program ready.

4. Connect: 'Every program needs a GO block on top to start — just like pressing play.'

Answer key (modelled by the run-gate)

Ex 1 — the start block is the green ⚑ GO block on top of Bit's program.

Ex 2 — Stack A is ready (the ⚑ GO block is on top); Stack B is not (its top block is a ➡ move block).

Ex 3 — a green ⚑ drawn in the top block: the stack is now ⚑ ➡ ➡ and ready to run.

Watch for & differentiate

Common idea: the start block is about POSITION (on top), not just colour — name both ('green AND on top').

Simplify: hand the child the 3 paper blocks and let them put the green flag on top before marking the page.

Extend: ask 'what runs second?' and 'what runs last?' to preview run-order (Sheet 2).

Movement option: line up children, the front child wears the 'GO' card — the line cannot move until the GO child is at the front.

Success looks like

The child points to the green ⚑ block as the start, picks Stack A as the ready one, and adds a GO block on top to make the empty stack ready to run.